LILI HUMAN · THE HUMAN NOTE FREEBIE

The Birthday Rescue Mission

A playful 15-minute parent-and-toddler workout

No equipment needed. Complete the five rescue missions three times:

• 40 seconds: Move and play • 20 seconds: Rest, celebrate, or switch roles • 3 rounds: 15 minutes total

1. Pup Patrol March

March around the room together while swinging your arms. Call out different pretend destinations: the lookout tower, the beach, the farm or the birthday party.

Make it fun: Let your child lead while you follow.



2. Pick Up the Pup Squats

Place a few stuffed animals or toys on the floor. Squat down, pick up one “pup,” stand tall and place it somewhere safe.

Parent cue: Sit your hips back and keep your feet firmly planted. Toddler option: Let them collect and carry the toys however they like.



3. Crawl Through the Rescue Tunnel

Crawl on hands and knees around cushions, under a table or through a simple blanket tunnel.

Parent option: Try a bear crawl with your knees hovering slightly above the floor, or stay on your hands and knees.



4. Helicopter Rescues

Stand tall with your arms stretched out like helicopter blades. Turn gently from side to side, then reach up high to “rescue” someone.

Make it fun: Add helicopter sounds and let your child choose where you fly.



5. Race to the Lookout

Choose a safe spot across the room. Walk quickly, march or carefully run toward it together. Touch the lookout and return to the starting point.

Small-space option: March quickly in place, then freeze when someone calls, “Pups, stop!”



Between each round

Celebrate with a different cheer:
Round 1: High-five. Round 2: Victory dance. Round 3: Big family hug.



The rescue mission ending

Sit or lie down together. Take three slow breaths, then ask:
“What was your favourite part of our rescue mission?”



Stop whenever either of you needs a break. If you're pregnant, recovering from an injury or have a health condition, check with your doctor before you start.

The goal isn't to finish every move. It's to make a memory.